MESA COHORT C4

AI and its Applications — Section 1 Final Examination

PROBLEM STATEMENT BOOKLET

Instructions to Students

1. Read your assigned problem statement carefully.
2. Your solution must use live external data wherever possible. The system must work with some data at the time of submission.
3. All AI tasks must use Gemini Flash. Do not use Claude API.
4. Deploy your solution on Vercel. Submit a working public URL along with your GitHub repository link and the Components Map.

Medium Difficulty

Startup Funding Pulse

Venture Intelligence • Investment Research • SaaS-able

Aarav is a venture scout at a Bengaluru-based family office that backs early-stage Indian startups. A core part of his job is staying current on what is getting funded — not just the individual deals, but the patterns behind them. Which sectors are attracting capital this week? Is deal activity in a space his portfolio touches accelerating or cooling? Has a new investor started making moves in his target verticals? This intelligence shapes which founders he reaches out to, which portfolio companies he flags for follow-up, and what he tells LPs about market direction. The Indian startup ecosystem generates forty to sixty funding announcements a week, scattered across press releases, startup media publications, investor LinkedIn posts, and financial newswires.

What Aarav currently does is skim two or three publications every morning and check his Twitter feed. He catches maybe sixty percent of notable deals and misses nearly everything in sectors he doesn't already follow closely. He keeps a spreadsheet where he logs deals relevant to his focus areas — the stage, amount,

lead investor, and sector — but it is perpetually three weeks behind and incomplete. Last month, two companies directly adjacent to a portfolio company raised within the same ten-day window. Aarav found out during a board meeting when the founder mentioned it. He should have known before the board meeting.

Aarav wants a Monday morning brief that consolidates the previous week's Indian startup funding activity from across every source where such announcements appear. He doesn't want a raw feed of headlines — he wants signal extracted from noise. The brief should surface deals in his focus sectors and stages first, identify any patterns Gemini can detect across the week's deal flow, and flag whether any announcement involves a company in his personal watchlist. His target sectors, stages, and watchlist companies should be stored in a config he can update himself as his mandate evolves. If the brief arrives before he opens his laptop Monday morning, he walks into the week knowing exactly where capital is moving.

> Build and deploy an AI-powered weekly startup funding intelligence digest for Aarav, delivered every Monday morning before he starts his week.